VOLUME 2C — THEORY NOTES: DESIGN-FOCUSED GENERAL AWARENESS, INDIAN ART & CULTURE, ARCHITECTURE

> This is **not** a UPSC GK book. Everything here was chosen because it (a) appeared in NID-style MCQs (logos, crafts, designers, architecture), (b) helps you draw authentic Indian context in subjective answers, or (c) is common material for the In-Person Sensitivity Test.
> These are **confirmed historical facts** unless marked otherwise. Recent events are in Volume 11.

1. About NID (know your institute; interview favourite)

Fact	Detail
Founded	**1961**, Ahmedabad
Origin	**"The India Report" (1958)** by **Charles and Ray Eames**, commissioned by the Government of India with Ford Foundation support. It recommended a design institute to address the needs of a modernising India.
Key founders	**Gira Sarabhai** and **Gautam Sarabhai** (of the Sarabhai family, Ahmedabad)
Status	Declared an **Institution of National Importance** by the **NID Act, 2014**
Campuses	Ahmedabad (main); Gandhinagar (PG); Bengaluru (R&D / PG)
Other NIDs (separate institutes)	NID Andhra Pradesh (Amaravati), NID Assam (Jorhat), NID Haryana (Kurukshetra), NID Madhya Pradesh (Bhopal). All were set up in the late 2010s, mentored by NID Ahmedabad.
Recent	Union Budget 2026-27 proposed a new NID in eastern India [REPORTED, 2026]
Other design schools in India	IDC School of Design (IIT Bombay, 1969), NIFT (1986), Srishti Manipal (Bengaluru), CEPT (Ahmedabad, architecture/planning), Sir J.J. School of Art (Mumbai, 1857), IIT Guwahati / IIT Hyderabad design departments, IIITDM Jabalpur, UCEED (the exam for IIT B.Des)

World design schools:

- **Bauhaus** (Germany, 1919–1933: Weimar → Dessau → Berlin)
- **Ulm School of Design / HfG Ulm** (1953–1968, Germany)
- **Royal College of Art** (London)
- **Rhode Island School of Design (RISD)** (USA)
- **Parsons School of Design** (New York)
- **Central Saint Martins** (London)
- **Design Academy Eindhoven** (Netherlands)
- **Pratt Institute** (New York)
- **Politecnico di Milano** (Italy)
- **ArtCenter College of Design** (Pasadena)
- **Stanford d.school** (design thinking)

2. Indian Folk & Tribal Painting Traditions

Art form	State / region	Key features	Notable names / facts
Madhubani / Mithila	Bihar (Mithila region)	Bold outlines, no empty space, double lines, fish, peacocks, gods; natural colours; styles include Bharni, Kachni, Tantrik, Godna, Kohbar	Sita Devi, Ganga Devi, Mahasundari Devi, Baua Devi (Padma Shri). GI tag.
Warli	Maharashtra (Thane, Palghar)	White rice-paste on a mud or red-ochre wall; **circle, triangle, square** (sun/moon, mountains, sacred enclosure); stick figures dancing in a spiral (Tarpa dance)	Jivya Soma Mashe (Padma Shri). Painted by the Warli tribe.
Gond	Madhya Pradesh	Dots, dashes and lines fill the forms; animals, trees, myths; vivid colours	**Jangarh Singh Shyam** (pioneer), **Bhajju Shyam** (*The London Jungle Book*), Durga Bai
Pithora	Gujarat / MP (Rathwa, Bhil tribes)	Ritual wall paintings, horses, painted for thanksgiving	—
Bhil	MP / Rajasthan / Gujarat	Dot patterns (like grains of maize)	Bhuri Bai (Padma Shri)
Saura	Odisha	Ritual wall paintings (*ittals*), similar to Warli but with more detailed figures	—
Sohrai & Khovar	Jharkhand (Hazaribagh)	Mural art for harvest (Sohrai) and marriage (Khovar), made with earth colours	GI tag
Pattachitra	Odisha (Raghurajpur) and West Bengal	Cloth-based scroll paintings; Jagannath themes; fine lines; natural colours; ornate borders	Raghurajpur heritage crafts village
Kalighat	Kolkata, West Bengal	19th-century bazaar paintings; bold sweeping brush lines; satire of the babu culture	Painted near the Kalighat Temple
Kalamkari	Andhra Pradesh	"Kalam" (pen) + "kari" (work). **Srikalahasti style** (freehand pen, mythological) and **Machilipatnam style** (block-printed, Persian motifs)	GI tags for both
Phad	Rajasthan (Bhilwara)	Long horizontal scrolls narrating the epics of folk deities **Pabuji** and **Devnarayan**; performed by Bhopa priests	Joshi family of painters
Tanjore / Thanjavur	Tamil Nadu	Gold foil, gems, relief work on wooden boards; Hindu deities; Maratha-period patronage	GI tag
Mysore painting	Karnataka	Like Tanjore but subtler, with less relief	—
Cheriyal scrolls	Telangana	Narrative scrolls in a comic-strip style; red backgrounds	GI tag
Thangka	Sikkim, Ladakh, Himachal	Buddhist painting on cotton or silk; mandalas	—
Manjusha	Bihar (Bhagalpur)	Snake motifs; Bihula–Bishahari legend; border-based	GI tag
Kalamezhuthu	Kerala	Ritual floor drawings made with coloured powders	—
Rangoli / Kolam / Alpana / Mandana	All India (Kolam = TN; Alpana = Bengal; Mandana = Rajasthan)	Floor patterns, often radial, for welcome and festivals	Kolam uses rice flour, a white line-and-dot grid

Indian Miniature Painting Schools

School	Period / region	Features
Pala	Bengal/Bihar, 8th–12th c.	Buddhist palm-leaf manuscripts; the earliest Indian miniatures
Mughal	16th–19th c.	Realism, court scenes, portraits, nature studies. Akbar (*Hamzanama*), Jahangir (Mansur's birds and animals), Shah Jahan. Persian influence.
Rajput / Rajasthani	16th–19th c.	Mewar, Bundi, Kota, Kishangarh, Marwar, Jaipur. Bright colours; Krishna and Radha. **Kishangarh: "Bani Thani" by Nihal Chand**, called the "Indian Mona Lisa".
Pahari	Himachal / Jammu, 17th–19th c.	Basohli (bold), Guler, **Kangra** (lyrical, delicate, Krishna themes)
Deccan	Bijapur, Golconda, Ahmednagar	Persian and Turkish influence; rich colours

Modern & Contemporary Indian Artists

Artist	Known for
Raja Ravi Varma (1848–1906)	Oil paintings of Hindu gods in a European academic style; oleographic printing press; *Shakuntala*, *Hamsa Damayanti*
Abanindranath Tagore	Bengal School founder; *Bharat Mata* (1905)
Rabindranath Tagore	Started painting at 60+; founded Santiniketan / Visva-Bharati (Santiniketan became a UNESCO site in 2023)
Nandalal Bose	Bengal School; illustrated the original **Constitution of India** manuscript; Haripura posters (1938)
Amrita Sher-Gil (1913–1941)	Hungarian-Indian modernist; *Three Girls*, *Bride's Toilet*
Jamini Roy	Drew on Kalighat and folk traditions; flat colours; bold outlines
M.F. Husain	Progressive Artists' Group; horses; *Mother Teresa* series
S.H. Raza	The **Bindu** (dot) series; geometric abstraction
F.N. Souza	Founder of the Progressive Artists' Group (1947, Bombay)
Tyeb Mehta	*Kali*, *Mahishasura*; diagonal splits
V.S. Gaitonde	Abstract, meditative works; record auction prices
Ram Kinkar Baij	Sculptor; *Santhal Family* (Santiniketan)
Satish Gujral	Painter, sculptor and architect; Belgian Embassy, Delhi
K.G. Subramanyan	Artist and educator (Baroda)
Bhupen Khakhar	Pop and narrative art (Baroda)
Anish Kapoor	British-Indian sculptor; *Cloud Gate* ("The Bean", Chicago)
Subodh Gupta	Steel utensil sculptures (*Very Hungry God*)
Bharti Kher	Bindi artworks
Atul Dodiya, **Jitish Kallat**, **Nalini Malani**	Contemporary installation and painting
R.K. Laxman	Cartoonist; *The Common Man* (Times of India); created the Asian Paints mascot **Gattu**
Mario Miranda	Goan cartoonist; crowded, detailed street scenes
Ram V. Sutar	Sculptor; **Statue of Unity** (182 m, Gujarat, 2018, the world's tallest statue)

3. Indian Textiles (high value for NID; Textile Design is one of the three main discipline groups)

3.1 Woven Saris & Fabrics

Textile	State	Identifying features
Banarasi	Uttar Pradesh (Varanasi)	Silk brocade with gold/silver zari; Mughal floral motifs (kalga, bel); GI
Kanjeevaram / Kanchipuram	Tamil Nadu	Heavy mulberry silk; contrasting borders woven separately and interlocked (**korvai** technique); temple motifs
Paithani	Maharashtra (Paithan, Yeola)	Peacock (muniya) and parrot motifs; oblique-square design; zari
Patola	Gujarat (Patan)	**Double ikat** silk: both warp and weft are tie-dyed before weaving. Extremely laborious; the Salvi family.
Pochampally Ikat	Telangana	Geometric ikat; GI
Sambalpuri / Bomkai	Odisha	Ikat (bandha) with tribal motifs
Chanderi	Madhya Pradesh	Sheer, light cotton-silk with buttis
Maheshwari	Madhya Pradesh	Cotton-silk; reversible border; Ahilyabai Holkar's patronage
Baluchari	West Bengal (Bishnupur)	Mythological and narrative scenes woven on the pallu
Jamdani	West Bengal / Bangladesh	Fine muslin with supplementary-weft motifs; inscribed on UNESCO's ICH list for Bangladesh (2013)
Muga silk	Assam	Naturally **golden** silk; GI; the mekhela chador
Eri silk	Assam / NE	"Ahimsa / peace silk" (the moth can emerge before the fibre is spun)
Pashmina	Kashmir / Ladakh	Fine wool from the Changthangi goat; Kani shawls (tapestry twill)
Kota Doria	Rajasthan	Small square checks (khat) in a light weave
Ilkal	Karnataka	Cotton with silk pallu; **tope teni** joining technique
Kasavu	Kerala	Off-white cotton with gold border; worn at Onam
Mangalagiri	Andhra Pradesh	Cotton with Nizam border
Bhagalpuri / Tussar	Bihar / Jharkhand	Wild (tasar) silk
Naga shawls	Nagaland	Tribe-specific colours and stripes

3.2 Embroidery

Embroidery	State	Features
Chikankari	Uttar Pradesh (Lucknow)	White-on-white shadow work on fine cotton; Nur Jahan legend; GI
Phulkari	Punjab / Haryana	"Flower work"; darn stitch with silk floss; Bagh = fully covered
Kantha	West Bengal / Odisha	Running stitch on layered old saris; upcycling
Kasuti	Karnataka	Geometric, counted-thread embroidery
Zardozi	UP, Delhi, Hyderabad	Metallic gold/silver thread; Persian origin
Kashida / Sozni	Kashmir	Fine needlework on shawls
Mirror work (Abhla bharat)	Gujarat (Kutch), Rajasthan	Small mirrors stitched in

Embroidery	State	Features
Toda embroidery (Pukhoor)	Tamil Nadu (Nilgiris)	Red and black on white
Chamba Rumal	Himachal Pradesh	Pahari-style embroidered handkerchiefs
Pipli appliqué	Odisha	Bright cut-cloth appliqué; Jagannath canopies
Lambani	Karnataka / Telangana	Mirrors, coins, bright colours (Banjara community)

3.3 Dyeing & Printing

Technique	Region	Features
Bandhani / Bandhej	Gujarat, Rajasthan	Tie-dye with tiny dots
Leheriya	Rajasthan	Diagonal wave-like stripes (*lehar* = wave)
Ajrakh	Gujarat (Kutch, Ajrakhpur) / Sindh	Resist block print; indigo + madder red; geometric
Sanganeri	Rajasthan	Fine floral block print on a white background
Bagru	Rajasthan	Dabu (mud-resist) printing; earthy colours
Dabu	Rajasthan	Mud-resist
Kalamkari (block)	AP (Machilipatnam)	See above
Bagh print	Madhya Pradesh	Red and black block print
Ikat	Odisha, Telangana, Gujarat	Yarn is resist-dyed *before* weaving (single or double)
Batik	(Indonesia origin), MP, WB	Wax-resist dyeing; crackle effect

Classic trap: ikat dyes the **yarn before weaving**; block printing and batik work on **finished cloth**.

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4. Indian Handicrafts

Craft	State	What it is
Blue Pottery	Rajasthan (Jaipur)	Quartz-based (not clay), cobalt-blue glaze; Turko-Persian origin
Bidriware	Karnataka (Bidar)	Blackened zinc-copper alloy inlaid with silver; GI
Dhokra / Dokra	Chhattisgarh, WB, Odisha, Jharkhand	Non-ferrous metal casting by the **lost-wax** method; tribal figurines
Channapatna toys	Karnataka	Lacquered wooden toys (originally ivory-wood); GI
Kondapalli toys	Andhra Pradesh	Light softwood (tella poniki) toys
Etikoppaka toys	Andhra Pradesh	Lacquer-turned toys with natural dyes
Nirmal toys / paintings	Telangana	—
Aranmula Kannadi	Kerala	A **metal-alloy mirror** (not glass); GI
Pietra dura / Parchinkari	UP (Agra)	Semi-precious stones inlaid in marble (as in the Taj Mahal)
Bankura terracotta horse	West Bengal	An iconic stylised horse
Longpi pottery	Manipur	Black pottery made **without a wheel**, from serpentine rock and clay
Thewa	Rajasthan (Pratapgarh)	Gold sheet fused onto glass
Meenakari	Rajasthan (Jaipur)	Enamelling on metal
Kashmiri papier-mâché	J&K	Painted paper pulp objects

Craft	State	What it is
Rogan art	Gujarat (Kutch, Nirona village)	Castor-oil-based paint drawn with a stylus
Sankheda furniture	Gujarat	Lacquered teak with painted designs
Kinnal craft	Karnataka	Wooden toys and figures
Bastar iron craft	Chhattisgarh	Wrought iron figures
Cane & bamboo	Assam, Tripura, Manipur	Furniture, baskets; the Assamese **jaapi** (hat)
Sikki grass craft	Bihar	Golden-grass baskets and figures
Tarkashi	Rajasthan	Brass wire inlay in wood
Kathputli	Rajasthan	String puppets
Leather puppets (Tholu Bommalata)	Andhra Pradesh	Shadow puppets
Bell metal (Kansa)	Odisha, Assam	Utensils
Khurja pottery	UP	Glazed ceramics
Shola pith	West Bengal	Decorations from shola plant pith (for Durga Puja)
Mata ni Pachedi	Gujarat	Temple cloth honouring the Mother Goddess
Coir craft	Kerala	Coconut fibre products

GI (Geographical Indication): a tag certifying that a product's quality or reputation comes from its place of origin. India's GI law is the *Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration and Protection) Act, 1999*, in force since 2003. The **first Indian GI was Darjeeling Tea (2004)**. The GI Registry is in **Chennai**.

UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage from India (selection):

- Kutiyattam
- Vedic chanting
- Ramlila
- Ramman
- Mudiyettu
- Kalbelia
- Chhau
- Buddhist chanting of Ladakh
- Sankirtana (Manipur)
- traditional brass and copper craft of the **Thatheras of Jandiala Guru** (Punjab)
- Yoga
- Nowruz
- Kumbh Mela
- **Durga Puja in Kolkata (2021)**
- **Garba of Gujarat (2023)**

India also had further nominations in the 2024–25 cycles; see Vol 11 for recent items.

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5. Indian Architecture

5.1 Timeline of Indian architecture (with icons)

Period	Key works	Features
Indus Valley (c. 2600–1900 BCE)	Mohenjo-daro (**Great Bath**), Harappa, **Dholavira** (UNESCO 2021), Lothal (dockyard)	Grid town planning, burnt bricks, covered drains
Mauryan (3rd c. BCE)	**Ashokan pillars**: the Lion Capital of **Sarnath**, India's national emblem; **Sanchi Stupa** (core by Ashoka)	Polished sandstone (the "Mauryan polish")
Buddhist rock-cut	**Ajanta** (murals, 2nd c. BCE–6th c. CE), **Karla chaitya**, **Ellora** (Buddhist, Hindu and Jain caves)	Chaitya (prayer hall) and vihara (monastery)
Gupta (4th–6th c.)	Dashavatara Temple (Deogarh), Udayagiri caves	The beginnings of the Hindu temple form
Early medieval temples	**Kailasa Temple, Ellora (Cave 16)**: carved top-down from a single rock under the Rashtrakuta king **Krishna I** (8th c.). **Pallava Mahabalipuram** (Shore Temple, Rathas, Arjuna's Penance).	Monolithic carving
Nagara style (North)	**Khajuraho** (Chandela), **Konark Sun Temple** (Odisha, 13th c., King Narasimhadeva I of the Eastern Ganga dynasty; designed as a chariot with 24 wheels and 7 horses), **Lingaraja** (Bhubaneswar), **Modhera Sun Temple** (Solanki)	Curvilinear **shikhara**; no boundary walls; the amalaka on top
Dravida style (South)	**Brihadeeswara Temple, Thanjavur** (Rajaraja Chola I, completed c. 1010 CE); Meenakshi Temple (Madurai); Hampi (Vijayanagara)	Pyramidal **vimana**; huge **gopurams** (gateways); enclosed courtyards
Vesara (Deccan hybrid)	**Hoysala temples**: Belur, Halebidu, Somanathapura (the **Sacred Ensembles of the Hoysalas**, UNESCO 2023); star-shaped plans; soapstone	Mixes Nagara and Dravida
Kakatiya	**Ramappa (Rudreswara) Temple**, Telangana (UNESCO 2021); floating bricks	—
Stepwells	**Rani ki Vav**, Patan (11th c., commissioned by Queen Udayamati; UNESCO 2014; shown on the ₹100 note); Adalaj (Gujarat); **Chand Baori** (Abhaneri, Rajasthan)	Water storage and a cooler microclimate
Indo-Islamic (Delhi Sultanate)	**Qutub Minar** (begun by Qutb-ud-din Aibak, completed by Iltutmish; about 73 m); **Alai Darwaza** (true arch, dome)	True arches, domes, calligraphy, geometric ornament
Provincial Islamic	**Gol Gumbaz** (Bijapur, Adil Shahi; a huge dome with a whispering gallery); **Charminar** (Hyderabad, 1591, Muhammad Quli Qutb Shah)	—
Mughal	**Humayun's Tomb** (Delhi, 1560s–70s, commissioned by Bega Begum, architect Mirak Mirza Ghiyas; the **first garden tomb** on the Indian subcontinent; charbagh). **Fatehpur Sikri** (Akbar; Buland Darwaza). **Taj Mahal** (Shah Jahan for Mumtaz Mahal, c. 1632–1653; chief architect usually credited as **Ustad Ahmad Lahauri**; white Makrana marble; pietra dura). **Red Fort** (Delhi). **Jama Masjid** (Delhi).	Charbagh (four-part garden), double domes, symmetry, red sandstone and white marble
Rajput	**Amber Fort**; **Hawa Mahal** (Jaipur, 1799, Lal Chand Ustad; 953 jharokhas); **Jantar Mantar** (Sawai Jai Singh II; UNESCO); Chittorgarh; Mehrangarh	Jharokha, chhatri, jaali
Colonial / Indo-Saracenic	**Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Terminus** (Mumbai, F.W. Stevens, 1888, Victorian Gothic + Indian; UNESCO); **Gateway of India** (George Wittet, 1924); **Victoria Memorial** (Kolkata, William Emerson); **Rashtrapati Bhavan** (Edwin Lutyens); **North & South Blocks** (Herbert Baker); old **Parliament House** (Lutyens & Baker, circular)	Domes, arches, chhatris + European plans

Period	Key works	Features
Modern	**Chandigarh** (Le Corbusier with Pierre Jeanneret; Capitol Complex part of a UNESCO transnational serial site, 2016); **IIM Ahmedabad** (Louis Kahn; brick arches); **Mill Owners' Association building** and **Sanskar Kendra**, Ahmedabad (Le Corbusier)	Béton brut (raw concrete), brutalism
Indian modernists	**B.V. Doshi**: Sangath (his studio), IIM Bangalore, **Aranya low-cost housing** (Indore), Amdavad ni Gufa (with M.F. Husain); **Pritzker 2018** (first Indian). **Charles Correa**: Gandhi Smarak Sangrahalaya (Sabarmati Ashram), Jawahar Kala Kendra (Jaipur; navagraha plan), Kanchanjunga Apartments (Mumbai), Navi Mumbai planning. **Laurie Baker**: low-cost brick architecture in Kerala, rat-trap bond, jaali walls. **Raj Rewal**: Hall of Nations (Pragati Maidan, demolished 2017), Asian Games Village. **Achyut Kanvinde**. **Anant Raje**. **Joseph Allen Stein**: India Habitat Centre. **Hafeez Contractor**: high-rises.	Climate-responsive modernism
Contemporary	**Lotus Temple** (Delhi, 1986, Fariborz Sahba; Bahá'í House of Worship); **Akshardham** (Delhi, 2005); **Statue of Unity** (2018); **New Parliament Building** (2023, **Bimal Patel / HCP Design**; triangular plan); **Navi Mumbai International Airport** (Zaha Hadid Architects; lotus-inspired; inaugurated 8 Oct 2025) [REPORTED, Vol 11]	—

5.2 UNESCO World Heritage Sites in India: key facts

- India's count **reached 44 with the Maratha Military Landscapes (2025)**: 12 forts, 11 in Maharashtra and **Gingee in Tamil Nadu**. **Sarnath** was reported as the **45th**, inscribed at the 48th session in Busan, South Korea, in July 2026. [REPORTED, verify]
- Recent inscriptions to remember:
  - **Dholavira** and **Ramappa** (2021)
  - **Santiniketan** and **Hoysala temples** (2023)
  - **Moidams of Charaideo, Assam** (2024: Ahom royal mound burials)
  - **Maratha Military Landscapes** (2025)
  - **Sarnath** (2026, reported)
- First Indian **World Heritage City**: **Ahmedabad (2017)**. **Jaipur** followed (2019).
- **Khangchendzonga National Park** (Sikkim, 2016) is India's only **mixed** (natural + cultural) site.

5.3 Architectural terms to know

Term	Meaning
Shikhara	Curved tower over the sanctum (North Indian)
Vimana	Pyramidal tower over the sanctum (South Indian)
Gopuram	Monumental gateway tower (South Indian)
Garbhagriha	Sanctum sanctorum ("womb chamber")
Mandapa	Pillared hall
Jaali	Perforated stone or wood screen (light, air, privacy)
Jharokha	Overhanging enclosed balcony
Chhatri	Elevated dome-shaped pavilion
Charbagh	Persian four-quadrant garden
Pishtaq	Formal gateway / arched portal of a Mughal building
Stupa	Hemispherical Buddhist reliquary mound (anda, harmika, chhatra, torana gateways)
Torana	Ornamental gateway (Sanchi)
Baoli / Vav	Stepwell

Term	Meaning
Haveli	Traditional courtyard mansion (Shekhawati frescoes)
Courtyard (aangan)	Climate and social core of Indian homes
Brutalism	Raw concrete, massive forms
Cantilever	A beam supported at one end only (Fallingwater)
Flying buttress	External support of Gothic cathedrals
Geodesic dome	Buckminster Fuller's triangulated dome

6. World Architecture & Architects

Architect	Country	Iconic works	Notes
Antoni Gaudí	Spain	Sagrada Família (unfinished), Casa Batlló, Park Güell	Catalan Modernisme
Frank Lloyd Wright	USA	**Fallingwater** (1935–39), **Guggenheim Museum NY** (spiral, 1959)	Organic architecture; Prairie style
Le Corbusier	Switzerland/France	**Villa Savoye**, Unité d'Habitation, Notre-Dame-du-Haut (Ronchamp), **Chandigarh**	**5 points of architecture**: pilotis, free plan, free façade, horizontal windows, roof garden; the **Modulor** proportion system; "a house is a machine for living in"
Walter Gropius	Germany	**Bauhaus** founder (1919); Bauhaus Dessau building	—
Ludwig Mies van der Rohe	Germany/USA	**Barcelona Pavilion** (1929), Seagram Building, Farnsworth House	"**Less is more**"; last Bauhaus director
Louis Kahn	USA	**IIM Ahmedabad**, National Assembly (Dhaka), Salk Institute	Monumental brick and concrete
Jørn Utzon	Denmark	**Sydney Opera House** (opened 1973)	Pritzker 2003
I.M. Pei	China/USA	**Louvre Pyramid** (1989), Bank of China Tower (HK)	—
Frank Gehry	Canada/USA	**Guggenheim Bilbao** (1997, titanium), Walt Disney Concert Hall, Dancing House (Prague, with Vlado Milunić)	Deconstructivism; the "Bilbao effect"
Zaha Hadid	Iraq/UK	Heydar Aliyev Center (Baku), MAXXI (Rome), London Aquatics Centre, Guangzhou Opera House	**First woman to win the Pritzker (2004)**; "Queen of the Curve"; died 2016. Her firm (ZHA) designed Navi Mumbai Airport.
Norman Foster	UK	**30 St Mary Axe ("The Gherkin")**, Reichstag dome, HSBC HK, Apple Park (with Apple)	High-tech
Renzo Piano	Italy	**Centre Pompidou** (with Richard Rogers, 1977; services exposed outside), **The Shard** (London)	—
Richard Rogers	UK	Lloyd's Building, Millennium Dome	High-tech

Architect	Country	Iconic works	Notes
Rem Koolhaas / OMA	Netherlands	CCTV HQ (Beijing), Seattle Central Library	—
Tadao Ando	Japan	**Church of the Light**, Row House in Sumiyoshi	Concrete, light, minimalism; a former boxer, self-taught
Kengo Kuma	Japan	**Japan National Stadium** (Tokyo 2020 Olympics), V&A Dundee	Timber, "anti-object"
Shigeru Ban	Japan	Paper-tube emergency shelters, Cardboard Cathedral (Christchurch)	Pritzker 2014; humanitarian architecture
SANAA (Sejima & Nishizawa)	Japan	21st Century Museum (Kanazawa), Louvre-Lens	Pritzker 2010
Oscar Niemeyer	Brazil	**Brasília** (Cathedral, National Congress)	Curves in concrete
Buckminster Fuller	USA	**Geodesic dome** (Montreal Biosphère, Expo 67)	"Spaceship Earth"
Eero Saarinen	Finland/USA	**Gateway Arch** (St. Louis), TWA Flight Center	Also designed the Tulip chair
Alvar Aalto	Finland	Paimio Sanatorium; Villa Mairea	Humane modernism; bent plywood
Bjarke Ingels (BIG)	Denmark	8 House, VIA 57 West, CopenHill (a waste-to-energy plant with a ski slope)	"Hedonistic sustainability"
Alejandro Aravena	Chile	**Quinta Monroy "half-houses"** (incremental housing)	Pritzker 2016
Diébédo Francis Kéré	Burkina Faso/Germany	Gando Primary School	**Pritzker 2022, first African laureate**
Gustave Eiffel	France	Eiffel Tower (1889 World's Fair); internal structure of the Statue of Liberty	Engineer
SOM (Adrian Smith)	USA	**Burj Khalifa** (828 m, 2010, the world's tallest)	Its Y-shaped plan was inspired by the *Hymenocallis* desert flower
Moshe Safdie	Israel/Canada	Habitat 67, Marina Bay Sands, Jewel Changi Airport	—
Herzog & de Meuron	Switzerland	**Beijing National Stadium ("Bird's Nest")**, Tate Modern conversion	—

Pritzker Prize (since **1979**; first laureate Philip Johnson). Recent winners:

Year	Laureate
2018	B.V. Doshi (India)
2019	Arata Isozaki (Japan)
2020	Yvonne Farrell & Shelley McNamara (Ireland)
2021	Anne Lacaton & Jean-Philippe Vassal (France)
2022	Diébédo Francis Kéré (Burkina Faso)
2023	David Chipperfield (UK)
2024	Riken Yamamoto (Japan)
2025	**Liu Jiakun** (China)

Year	Laureate
2026	**Smiljan Radić Clarke** (Chile) [REPORTED 2026; designed the Serpentine Pavilion 2014 and the Biobío Regional Theatre]

Architecture movements

Movement	Era	Characteristics	Examples
Gothic	12th–16th c.	Pointed arches, ribbed vaults, flying buttresses, stained glass	Notre-Dame (Paris)
Renaissance	15th–17th c.	Classical symmetry, domes	Florence Cathedral dome (Brunelleschi), St Peter's
Baroque	17th c.	Drama, curves, ornament	Versailles
Art Nouveau	1890–1910	Organic, flowing plant lines	Gaudí, Victor Horta, Paris Métro entrances (Hector Guimard)
Art Deco	1920s–30s	Geometric, streamlined, luxurious	Chrysler Building; **Mumbai's Marine Drive** (Victorian Gothic and Art Deco Ensembles of Mumbai, UNESCO 2018)
Modernism / International Style	1920s–60s	Function, no ornament, steel, glass, concrete	Villa Savoye, Seagram Building
Brutalism	1950s–70s	Raw concrete, massive forms	Barbican; parts of Chandigarh
Postmodernism	1970s–90s	Playful, historic quotes, colour	Robert Venturi; Michael Graves
Deconstructivism	1980s+	Fragmented, non-rectilinear	Gehry, Hadid, Libeskind
High-tech	1970s+	Exposed structure and services	Centre Pompidou, Lloyd's
Parametric	2000s+	Computational curves	Zaha Hadid Architects
Sustainable / green	Now	Passive design, green roofs, net-zero	Bosco Verticale (Milan, Stefano Boeri)

7. Designers: Master Tables

7.1 Indian designers & design figures

Name	Field	Known for
D. Udaya Kumar	Graphic	Designed the **₹ rupee symbol** (adopted 2010)
Gira & Gautam Sarabhai	Institution-builders	Founded NID; Calico Museum of Textiles
M.P. Ranjan	Design educator (NID)	*Handmade in India*; bamboo and cane design research
Kirti Trivedi	Graphic / typography	IDC educator; Indian visual traditions
R.K. Joshi	Typography / calligraphy	Devanagari type design pioneer
Mukund Gokhale	Type designer	Devanagari typefaces
Sudarshan Dheer	Graphic	Pioneer of Indian corporate identities
Rajeev Sethi	Scenographer / craft revivalist	Festival of India exhibitions; Asian Heritage Foundation
Satyendra Pakhalé	Industrial	Amsterdam-based Indian product designer
Sandeep Sangaru	Product / furniture	Bamboo furniture

Name	Field	Known for
Ayush Kasliwal	Product / craft	Contemporary craft-based products
Ritu Kumar	Fashion	Revived Indian textiles; block prints
Sabyasachi Mukherjee	Fashion	Bridal couture; heritage textiles
Manish Malhotra	Fashion / costume	Bollywood costume design
Rohit Bal	Fashion	Lotus and peacock motifs (died 2024)
Rahul Mishra	Fashion	Hand embroidery; Paris Haute Couture Week
Anita Dongre	Fashion	Sustainable craft fashion (Grassroot)
Gaurav Gupta	Fashion	Sculptural couture
Masaba Gupta	Fashion	Quirky Indian prints
Bhanu Athaiya	Costume	**First Indian Oscar winner** (*Gandhi*, 1983, Best Costume Design)
Ashok Chatterjee	Former NID Director	Craft advocacy
Hafeez Contractor, **B.V. Doshi**, **Charles Correa**, **Laurie Baker**	Architecture	See §5

7.2 International graphic designers & typographers

Name	Country	Known for
Paul Rand	USA	Logos for **IBM**, ABC, UPS (1961), Westinghouse
Milton Glaser	USA	**I ♥ NY** (1977); the Bob Dylan poster
Saul Bass	USA	Film title sequences (*Vertigo*, *Psycho*); AT&T logo
Massimo Vignelli	Italy/USA	**NYC Subway map (1972)**; American Airlines identity
Harry Beck	UK	**London Underground diagram (1931/33)**, the topological map
Edward Johnston	UK	**Johnston typeface** (London Underground, 1916)
Otl Aicher	Germany	**Munich 1972 Olympic pictograms**; Lufthansa identity
Josef Müller-Brockmann	Switzerland	Grid systems; Swiss / International Typographic Style
Max Miedinger (with Eduard Hoffmann)	Switzerland	**Helvetica (1957)**, originally "Neue Haas Grotesk"
Adrian Frutiger	Switzerland	**Univers**, **Frutiger** (Charles de Gaulle Airport signage)
Paul Renner	Germany	**Futura (1927)**
Eric Gill	UK	**Gill Sans**, Perpetua
Stanley Morison	UK	**Times New Roman (1932)** for *The Times*
Matthew Carter	UK/USA	**Verdana, Georgia** (screen fonts for Microsoft)
Herb Lubalin	USA	ITC Avant Garde
Jan Tschichold	Germany	*Die neue Typographie* (1928); Penguin book redesign
Claude Garamond / **John Baskerville** / **Giambattista Bodoni**	France / UK / Italy	Classic serif typefaces
Johannes Gutenberg	Germany	Movable-type printing press (c. 1440)
Carolyn Davidson	USA	**Nike Swoosh (1971)**, famously for $35

Name	Country	Known for
Rob Janoff	USA	**Apple rainbow logo (1977)**
Lindon Leader	USA	**FedEx logo** (1994), with the hidden arrow
Susan Kare	USA	Original **Macintosh icons** and fonts
Paula Scher	USA	Citibank, The Public Theater identities
Chermayeff & Geismar	USA	Chase, NBC peacock, Mobil, PBS
Alan Fletcher	UK	V&A logo; co-founded Pentagram
Shepard Fairey	USA	Obama *"Hope"* poster (2008)

7.3 Industrial / product & furniture designers

Name	Country	Known for
Dieter Rams	Germany	Braun products (SK 4 record player, T3 radio); **10 principles**; Vitsœ 606 shelving
Jony Ive	UK	Apple: iMac G3 (1998), iPod, iPhone, MacBook
Raymond Loewy	France/USA	"Father of industrial design": Lucky Strike pack, Shell logo, Greyhound Scenicruiser, Studebaker; **MAYA principle** ("Most Advanced Yet Acceptable")
Charles & Ray Eames	USA	**Eames Lounge Chair (1956)**, moulded plywood chairs; *Powers of Ten* film; **The India Report (1958)**
Marcel Breuer	Hungary/Germany	**Wassily Chair** (1925, tubular steel, inspired by bicycle handlebars)
Mies van der Rohe	Germany	**Barcelona Chair** (1929)
Gerrit Rietveld	Netherlands	**Red and Blue Chair** (c. 1918); Rietveld Schröder House (De Stijl)
Michael Thonet	Germany/Austria	**No. 14 bistro chair (1859)**, steam-bent beechwood; flat-packed
Arne Jacobsen	Denmark	Egg Chair, Swan Chair, Series 7 chair
Hans Wegner	Denmark	Wishbone Chair
Alvar Aalto	Finland	Paimio Chair, Stool 60, **Savoy vase**
Eero Saarinen	Finland/USA	**Tulip Chair** (pedestal base)
Verner Panton	Denmark	**Panton Chair** (the first single-piece moulded plastic cantilever chair)
Philippe Starck	France	**Juicy Salif** citrus squeezer (Alessi, 1990), Louis Ghost chair
Ettore Sottsass	Italy	**Olivetti Valentine typewriter** (1969); founder of the **Memphis Group** (1981)
Marc Newson	Australia	Lockheed Lounge
Naoto Fukasawa	Japan	MUJI wall-mounted CD player; "without thought" design
Kenji Ekuan	Japan	**Kikkoman soy sauce dispenser (1961)**; Shinkansen designs
Sori Yanagi	Japan	**Butterfly Stool** (1954)
Isamu Noguchi	USA/Japan	**Akari** paper lamps; Noguchi coffee table
Ferdinand Porsche	Austria/Germany	**Volkswagen Beetle**
Dante Giacosa	Italy	**Fiat 500** (1957)
Alec Issigonis	UK	**Mini** (1959)
Corradino D'Ascanio	Italy	**Vespa** scooter (1946)
Karim Rashid	Egypt/Canada	Garbo trash can; "blobject" style

Name	Country	Known for
Konstantin Grcic	Germany	Chair_One
Yves Béhar	Switzerland/USA	Jawbone; One Laptop per Child XO

7.4 Fashion designers

Name	Country	Known for
Coco Chanel	France	The little black dress; Chanel No. 5; tweed suit; liberated women's fashion
Christian Dior	France	**"New Look" (1947)**
Yves Saint Laurent	France	*Le Smoking* tuxedo for women (1966); Mondrian dress (1965)
Cristóbal Balenciaga	Spain	Sculptural couture
Giorgio Armani	Italy	Unstructured suits (died 2025)
Issey Miyake	Japan	*Pleats Please*; A-POC (died 2022)
Rei Kawakubo	Japan	Comme des Garçons; deconstruction
Yohji Yamamoto	Japan	Black, oversized avant-garde
Vivienne Westwood	UK	Punk fashion (died 2022)
Alexander McQueen	UK	Theatrical shows
Karl Lagerfeld	Germany	Chanel creative director (1983–2019)
Ralph Lauren	USA	Polo; American preppy

8. Art Movements (world)

Movement	Period	Key artists	Features
Renaissance	14th–17th c.	Leonardo (*Mona Lisa*, *The Last Supper*), Michelangelo (Sistine Chapel, *David*), Raphael	Linear perspective (Brunelleschi), humanism, realism
Baroque	17th c.	Caravaggio, Rembrandt, Rubens	Drama; **chiaroscuro** (strong light and dark)
Romanticism	late 18th–19th c.	Delacroix, Turner, Goya	Emotion, nature's power
Realism	mid-19th c.	Courbet, Millet	Everyday life
Impressionism	1870s	**Monet** (*Impression, Sunrise* gave the movement its name), Renoir, Degas	Light, outdoor painting (en plein air), visible brushstrokes
Post-Impressionism	1880s–1900s	**Van Gogh** (*The Starry Night*), Cézanne, Gauguin, **Seurat** (pointillism: *A Sunday Afternoon on the Island of La Grande Jatte*)	Expressive colour, structure
Art Nouveau	1890–1910	Alphonse Mucha, Gustav Klimt (*The Kiss*)	Organic lines, decorative
Expressionism	1905–1920s	**Edvard Munch** (*The Scream*), Kirchner	Emotional distortion
Fauvism	1905	**Henri Matisse**	Wild, non-natural colour
Cubism	1907–1920s	**Picasso** (*Les Demoiselles d'Avignon*, *Guernica* 1937), **Georges Braque**	Multiple viewpoints, geometric fragmentation
Futurism	1909 (Italy)	Boccioni, Balla	Speed, machines, motion

Movement	Period	Key artists	Features
Dada	1916 (Zurich)	**Marcel Duchamp** (*Fountain*, 1917, a urinal "readymade")	Anti-art, absurdity
Surrealism	1924+	**Salvador Dalí** (*The Persistence of Memory*, melting clocks), René Magritte (*The Treachery of Images*: "Ceci n'est pas une pipe"), Frida Kahlo (associated)	Dreams, the unconscious
De Stijl	1917 (Netherlands)	**Piet Mondrian**, Theo van Doesburg, Rietveld	Primary colours + black/white, horizontal and vertical grids
Bauhaus	1919–1933	Gropius, Kandinsky, Klee, Moholy-Nagy, Josef Albers, Marianne Brandt, Anni Albers	Unity of art, craft and technology; "form follows function" applied
Constructivism	1915+ (Russia)	Tatlin, Rodchenko, El Lissitzky	Art for social purpose; graphic posters
Art Deco	1920s–30s	Cassandre (posters), Erté	Geometry, luxury, streamlining
Abstract Expressionism	1940s–50s (NY)	**Jackson Pollock** (drip painting), Mark Rothko (colour fields), de Kooning	Gesture, emotion, large scale
Pop Art	1950s–60s	**Andy Warhol** (*Campbell's Soup Cans*, Marilyn), Roy Lichtenstein (comic dots), Richard Hamilton	Consumer culture, mass media
Op Art	1960s	**Bridget Riley**, **Victor Vasarely**	Optical illusions
Minimalism	1960s	Donald Judd, Dan Flavin, Agnes Martin	Simple geometric forms
Memphis Design	1981–88	Ettore Sottsass	Bold colours, kitsch geometry, anti-modernist
Street art	1980s+	Banksy, Keith Haring, Jean-Michel Basquiat	Public, political

Design movements (summary):

- **Arts and Crafts** (William Morris, 1860s–1910, UK): a reaction against industrial mass production; handcraft.
- Art Nouveau.
- Deutscher Werkbund (1907).
- Bauhaus.
- Streamlining (1930s USA, Loewy).
- **Mid-century modern** (1945–1970: Eames, Saarinen).
- **Scandinavian design** (functional, natural materials).
- Swiss / International Typographic Style.
- Memphis.
- Postmodern.
- **Flat design** (2010s UI; Windows Metro, iOS 7 in 2013).
- **Skeuomorphism** (UI that imitates real materials: early iOS).
- **Neumorphism** (2020s).
- Apple's **"Liquid Glass"** design language (2025).

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9. Famous Logos & Brands (frequently tested in MCQ years)

Logo	Hidden or notable feature	Designer / year (where known)
FedEx	Hidden arrow between E and x	Lindon Leader, Landor (1994)
Amazon	Arrow from **a to z** = a smile	Turner Duckworth (2000)
Apple	Bitten apple; "bite"/"byte" pun; rainbow version 1977–1998	Rob Janoff
Nike	Swoosh = the wing of Nike, Greek goddess of victory	Carolyn Davidson (1971)
Toyota	Three ovals; all letters of TOYOTA can be traced in the emblem	1989
Baskin-Robbins	Pink "31" in "BR" (31 flavours)	—
Tour de France	A cyclist hidden in the letter R	—
Toblerone	A bear hidden in the Matterhorn (the symbol of Bern)	—
WWF	Panda; **closure** principle	Peter Scott (1961); refined by Landor (1986)
Olympic rings	Five interlocking rings (blue, yellow, black, green, red on white). At least one of these colours appears in every nation's flag.	Pierre de Coubertin (1913)
Mercedes-Benz	Three-pointed star = land, sea, air	—
Audi	Four rings = the four merged companies (Auto Union)	—
BMW	Roundel in Bavarian blue and white (often wrongly said to be a propeller)	—
Starbucks	Twin-tailed siren (mermaid)	—
Shell	Scallop shell	Raymond Loewy redesign (1971)
McDonald's	Golden Arches	—
Pepsi	Globe	—
Google	Multicoloured wordmark; sans-serif since 2015 (Product Sans)	—
Unilever	The "U" is made of 25 icons (sun, hand, DNA, etc.)	Wolff Olins (2004)
Wikipedia	An incomplete puzzle globe	—
Indian brands	**Amul girl** (mascot, 1966, by Sylvester daCunha's agency; Eustace Fernandes drew her); **Air India Maharaja** (Bobby Kooka & Umesh Rao, 1946); **Tata** "T" (a well of knowledge); **LIC** (two hands protecting a lamp; motto "Yogakshemam Vahamyaham"); **Asian Paints Gattu** (R.K. Laxman); **India Post** (red, with a flying-envelope bird)	—
Indian govt symbols	**National emblem** (adapted from the **Lion Capital of Ashoka, Sarnath**; motto *Satyameva Jayate* from the Mundaka Upanishad); **₹ symbol** (Devanagari "₹" + Roman "R" + a double line suggesting the tricolour / equality sign); **Swachh Bharat** logo (Gandhi's spectacles); **Make in India** lion (made of cogs); **Incredible India** (the "!" as the letter i)	—

10. Iconic Products (often asked: "who designed / which brand")

Product	Designer / company	Year	Why iconic
Coca-Cola contour bottle	Earl R. Dean (Root Glass Co.)	1915	Recognisable by touch in the dark
Thonet No. 14 chair	Michael Thonet	1859	Mass production; flat-pack
Swiss Army Knife	Karl Elsener (Victorinox)	1891	Multi-function
Zippo lighter	George Blaisdell	1933	Windproof
Anglepoise lamp	George Carwardine	1932	Spring-balanced arm
Moka pot	Alfonso Bialetti	1933	Octagonal aluminium
Vespa	Corradino D'Ascanio / Piaggio	1946	Step-through frame
Polaroid SX-70	Edwin Land / Polaroid	1972	Instant photography
Sony Walkman	Sony (Akio Morita, Masaru Ibuka)	1979	Personal music
iPhone	Apple (Jony Ive's team)	2007	Multi-touch smartphone
Monobloc plastic chair	(Many; Henry Massonnet's "Fauteuil 300", 1972)	1970s	The world's most common chair
Indian icons	**Ambassador car** (Hindustan Motors; based on the Morris Oxford); **Bajaj Chetak** scooter; **Royal Enfield Bullet**; **Hero/Atlas bicycles**; **Prestige/Hawkins pressure cooker**; **Tata Nano** (2008, "₹1 lakh car"); **Godrej Storwel almirah**; **steel tiffin / dabba**; **Bajaj fan**; the **kulhad**; **Jaipur Foot** (prosthetic limb, Dr P.K. Sethi & Ram Chandra Sharma, 1969)		

11. Museums, Institutions & Awards

Museums (India):

- **National Museum** (Delhi)
- **NGMA** (National Gallery of Modern Art: Delhi, Mumbai, Bengaluru)
- **Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Vastu Sangrahalaya** (Mumbai; formerly the Prince of Wales Museum)
- **Indian Museum** (Kolkata, 1814, the oldest in India)
- **Salar Jung Museum** (Hyderabad)
- **Calico Museum of Textiles** (Ahmedabad)
- **Crafts Museum** (National Handicrafts and Handlooms Museum, Delhi; designed by Charles Correa)
- **Kiran Nadar Museum of Art** (Delhi)
- **Dr. Bhau Daji Lad Museum** (Mumbai)
- **Pradhanmantri Sangrahalaya** (Delhi, 2022)
- **Museum of Art & Photography (MAP)** (Bengaluru, 2023)

Museums (world):

- **Louvre** (Paris; Mona Lisa)
- **MoMA** (New York; its design collection)
- **Metropolitan Museum of Art** (New York)
- **Victoria and Albert Museum (V&A)** (London; art and design)
- **Design Museum** (London)
- **Vitra Design Museum** (Weil am Rhein, Germany; building by Gehry)
- **Cooper Hewitt, Smithsonian Design Museum** (New York)
- **Guggenheim** (New York, Bilbao)
- **Tate Modern** (London)
- **Uffizi** (Florence)
- **Rijksmuseum** and **Van Gogh Museum** (Amsterdam)
- **Prado** (Madrid)
- **Hermitage** (St Petersburg)
- **Louvre Abu Dhabi** (Jean Nouvel)
- **Grand Egyptian Museum** (Giza; fully opened Nov 2025)

Design awards & events:

- **Red Dot** (Germany)
- **iF Design Award** (Germany)
- **Compasso d'Oro** (Italy, since 1954, an idea of Gio Ponti; the "Oscar of design")
- **Good Design Award** (Japan's G Mark; also Chicago)
- **IDSA IDEA** (USA)
- **D&AD Pencils** (UK)
- **Cannes Lions** (advertising)
- **India Design Mark** (the I Mark, by the India Design Council)
- **CII Design Excellence Awards**
- **Kyoorius Design Awards** (India)

Design weeks & fairs:

- **Milan Design Week / Salone del Mobile** (April)
- **India Design ID** (New Delhi, February)
- **London Design Festival** (September)
- **Dutch Design Week** (Eindhoven, October)

Biennales:

- **Venice Biennale** (art and architecture in alternate years)
- **Kochi-Muziris Biennale** (India's largest; started 2012)
- **India Art Fair** (Delhi)
- **Serendipity Arts Festival** (Goa)

World Design Organization (WDO) names the **World Design Capital**: Torino 2008 (the first), Seoul 2010, Helsinki 2012, Cape Town 2014, Taipei 2016, Mexico City 2018, Lille Metropole 2020, Valencia 2022, San Diego–Tijuana 2024, **Frankfurt Rhine-Main 2026** (the first in Germany; theme "Design for Democracy").

India Design Council was set up under the **National Design Policy (2007)**.

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12. Sustainability, Technology & AI in Design (concepts)

- **Circular design**, **biomaterials** (mycelium packaging, banana-fibre textiles, Piñatex from pineapple leaves), **upcycling**, **zero-waste fashion**, **slow fashion** vs fast fashion.
- **Universal design / accessibility**: the Accessible India Campaign (Sugamya Bharat Abhiyan, 2015).
- **Generative AI in design**: text-to-image tools, AI-assisted layouts, the ethics of training data and authorship. **Human-in-the-loop** design keeps humans in charge of judgement, empathy and context.
- **UI/UX**: user interface vs user experience; wireframes; prototypes; user testing.
- **3D printing / additive manufacturing**; **CNC**; **parametric design**; **digital twins**.
- **Smart cities**: India's Smart Cities Mission (2015).
- **Electric mobility**: EV design, charging infrastructure.

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